FACULTY COLUMN



DR M. SRINIVAS
Director, AIIMS Delhi

The Pinnacle Is Not Enough

The founding mission of AIIMS Delhi included achieving self-reliance in advanced medical education. Education and research are conducted across nearly 100 disciplines. In 2024 alone, the institute managed 906 extramural research projects funded by national and international organisations and supported 269 intramural research initiatives, with a cumulative grant value exceeding Rs 208 crore. AIIMS Delhi students receive exposure to a diverse array of clinical cases and cutting-edge diagnostic and therapeutic technologies. Responding to evolving healthcare needs, AIIMS has introduced new academic programmes—including a DM in Psychosomatic Medicine under the Department of Psychiatry.

The institute places strong emphasis on student wellness. The Department of Psychiatry operates an on-campus wellness centre for students. Recently, an intramural research funding scheme specifically designed to empower postgraduate researchers, was launched.

"AIIMS Delhi is making strides in applying AI in areas like oncology, medical imaging opthalmology and dermatology"

Key developments and initiatives at AIIMS Delhi include the K.L. Wig Centre for Medical Education, Technology & Innovation (CMETi) that hosted multiple capacity-building programmes for faculty and students, and Robotic Surgery Training Facility (MeHNAT), a high-tech training initiative leveraging Medtronic Hugo robotic systems to equip residents and faculty with advanced surgical skills via the SET (Skills, E-learning, Telemedicine) Facility. The SET Facility is the backbone of the National Medical College Network under the Union ministry of health. It supports e-Education and national telehealth efforts by linking medical colleges across India. A wide range of digital learning tools are accessible to students too. Finally, AIIMS Delhi is making notable strides in applying Artificial Intelligence to domains like oncology, medical imaging, ophthalmology and dermatology. It has been designated as a Centre of Excellence for AI/ML by the Union ministries of health and education. ■

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